DT Fellowship Simulation Assignment

Your Assignment

Part 1: Funnel Design + CRM Structuring

1. Funnel Design Simulation

You are tasked with designing the company's sales funnel.

For a B2B SaaS product with a sales cycle of 4–6 weeks, define:
What counts as:

- **Lead**
- **MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead)**
- **SQL (Sales Qualified Lead)**
- **Customer**

What criteria or activities upgrade a lead to the next stage?
Which department owns each transition (e.g., Marketing → Sales → CS)?
Bonus: Add one extra funnel stage (optional) that you believe will make the system more effective — explain your logic.

Answer : -

Funnel Design Simulation – For a B2B SaaS Company (4–6 week sales cycle)

1. Lead

Who ?

Any person or company who has filled a form on our website, or clicked on an ad/post. Meaning there is interest, but the seriousness is not clear.

Example :

Rajneesh saw an ad on Facebook and filled the form now he is a lead.

2. MQL (Marketing Qualified Lead)

Who ?

The lead who has done some meaningful action like attended a webinar, downloaded a free e-book, or engaged with the founder's post on LinkedIn.

Criteria to qualify as MQL :

- Company size matches (target customer)
- Industry is relevant
- Have engaged at least 2 times

Owned by : Marketing Team

Marketing will nurture till here.

3. SQL (Sales Qualified Lead)

Who ?

The lead from MQL who has become interested for demo or has scheduled a sales call. Meaning now he can become a real buyer.

Criteria to qualify as SQL :

- Demo has been booked
- Budget is confirmed
- Contact with decision-maker is established

Owned by : Sales Team

Sales team will now take it till closure.

4. Customer

Who ?

The one who has purchased the product/service payment done and onboarding starts.

Criteria :

- Contract signed
- Payment done
- Product access given

Owned by : Customer Success Team (CS)

CS will ensure that the product is being used, and feedback will be collected.

Bonus Stage : PQL (Product Qualified Lead)

Why Add This ?

In B2B SaaS, if someone shows active interest by using a free trial of the product (like onboarding 5+ people, or using 3+ features), then that is PQL.

Logic :

PQL gives a powerful signal that the lead has an actual usage and there are high chances that the lead will become a customer. At this stage, there is also more scope for sending personalized nudges from AI.

Owned by : Sales + Growth Team Combo

Here close monitoring and fast engagement is a must.

Funnel Transition Summary Table

Stage	Criteria	Owner
Lead	Filled form / clicked ad	Marketing
MQL	Multiple engagements + target match	Marketing
SQL	Booked demo + budget clarity	Sales
PQL	Trial used + key feature adopted	Growth/Sales
Customer	Paid & onboarded	Customer Success

Final Thought

A correct funnel means clarity at every stage. If every team understands its responsibility and the handover is smooth, then the CAC of the business will be less and LTV will increase.

Funnel is like a GPS to take every lead on the right track without any confusion.

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2. CRM Configuration Blueprint

Your CEO wants to set up HubSpot, Zoho, or a Notion-based CRM.

Define:

- The **core data fields** you will track per contact (e.g., Lead Source, Industry, Last Engagement Date)
- The **automations** you would set up (e.g., auto-tagging, lifecycle stage updates, reminders)
- The **dashboard views** you would configure for:
    - Sales Reps
    - Growth Manager
    - CEO

Answer :-

Core Data Fields per Contact (lead)

I will keep these fields which will help in business decisions :

1. Full Name – Lead name

2. Company Name – Where does lead come from?

3. Email & Phone Number – for communication

4. Lead Source – FB Ads, LinkedIn, Referral, etc.

5. Industry – Which field is the business in?

6. Job Title – Decision-maker or not

7. Lead Stage – Lead, MQL, SQL, etc.

8. Last Engagement Date – When was the last touch made

9. Deal Size (Estimated) – Potential revenue

10. Owner (Team Member) – To whom is this lead assigned

11. Pain Points/Needs – Notes on their problem

12. Status – Active, Converted, Lost

From these fields you can clearly see which lead is the priority and which one is to be nurtured.

Automations I will Set Up

To make CRM smart, reduce manual work and conversion fast :

Auto-tagging based on Source

- FB Ads only auto-tag is "Inbound"
- LinkedIn only tags are "Outbound"

Lifecycle Stage Updates

- When a lead books a demo → Auto MQL
- When proposal is accepted → Auto SQL

Reminders & Follow-ups

- If no activity since 3 days → Auto reminder to Sales
- If no response from 7 days → Nurturing mail auto-send

Lead Scoring Automation

- High interaction + Relevant industry = High score
- Low interaction = Low score → Move to cold list

Notification to Owner

- When lead engages (mail open, link click) → alert to owner

Dashboard Views Configuration

For Sales Reps :

- My Active Leads
- Follow-ups Due Today
- Hot Leads (High Score + Recent Activity)
- Conversion Funnel View

Sales team just login and understand who to call today.

For Growth Manager :

- Lead Source Performance (FB vs Email vs LinkedIn)
- Conversion Rates by Stage
- CAC by Channel
- Content Performance (which email gets more replies)

Growth managers will get system insights where leads are coming from and what work they are doing.

For CEO :

- Weekly Funnel Summary (Leads → MQL → SQL → Customer)
- Top Performing Channels
- CAC vs LTV Graph
- Team Performance (conversion by rep)
- Bottlenecks (Where most leads are stuck)

The CEO got clarity “Where is my money going and what results are I getting”.

The goal of my CRM is to eliminate manual work, show priority and bring clarity. This CRM is not just a tool to collect data, it is a growth system in which every team knows its role and the founder gets the confidence that “the system is working”.

Part 2: Nurturing Mechanism Design

The leads are cold and go dark. The CEO is frustrated.
Your job: Design **3 nurturing tracks** based on lead intent level:

1. **High-Intent Lead:** Booked a demo but didn’t convert
2. **Mid-Intent Lead:** Downloaded a resource or joined a webinar
3. **Low-Intent Lead:** Just subscribed to newsletter

For each, define:

- Frequency and channels (e.g., email, WhatsApp, LinkedIn)
- Type of content (e.g., case study, founder note, offer)
- Success metric (e.g., reply rate, demo booked, re-engagement)

Bonus: Mention what AI tools (if any) you’d use to personalize or scale nurturing.

Answer :-

Nurturing Strategy (Based on Intent Levels)

1. High-Intent Lead

They had booked demo, but did not convert.

“Almost ready to buy, just need a little trust and push.”

Frequency & Channels :

- 2–3 touchpoints/week
- Channels: Email + WhatsApp + LinkedIn DM

Type of Content :

- Personalized case study (of the same industry)
- Limited-time offer or discount
- Founder's personal message (Why we built this product)

Success Metric :

- Demo re-booked
- Positive reply
- Conversion within 2 weeks

AI Tools :

- ChatGPT to generate personalized follow-up messages
- Lavender for cold email optimization
- Hyperise for personalized images in emails

2. Mid-Intent Lead

He downloaded the resource or joined the webinar.

“Interest is there, but the decision is at the door.”

Frequency & Channels :

- 2 mails/week + 1 LinkedIn ping in 10 days
- Channels: Email + LinkedIn

Type of Content :

- Educational blogs on their pain points
- Webinar replay link + key insights
- Use-case videos or customer stories

Success Metric :

- Click-through rate
- Sign-up for demo
- Re-engagement (reply or content download)

AI Tools :

- HubSpot AI Sequences for automated email flow
- Grammarly to refine tone
- ChatGPT for summarizing webinars into bullet follow-ups

3. Low-Intent Lead

Just subscribed to the newsletter.

“Unaware or top-of-funnel. Build trust.”

Frequency & Channels :

- 1 email/week
- Channel: Email only

Type of Content :

- Monthly newsletters
- Light case studies
- Company milestones/founder story
- Community invite (e.g., Slack group, events)

Success Metric :

- open rate
- clicks
- Lead moving to Mid-Intent action (resource download etc.)

AI Tools :

- Mailchimp AI for newsletter subject line A/B testing
- ChatGPT for writing engaging, human-style newsletter copy
- Zapier to auto-segment based on actions

Final Thought

“Spamming every lead does not work. Nurturing must be done according to their mindset. Personalization is power. Intent itself gives direction.”

Part 3: Funnel Analytics & CAC Optimization

Your goal: Cut CAC by 40% in the next quarter.
You’re given the following mock data (or create your own):

Stage	Leads	Cost Incurred	Conversions	Conversion Rate	Cost per Conversion
Facebook Ads	3000	₹90,000	30	1%	₹3,000
Email Campaign	1000	₹10,000	25	2.5%	₹400
LinkedIn DMs	500	₹25,000	10	2%	₹2,500

Questions :

- Which channel is underperforming? Why?
- Propose 2 experiments to improve conversion or reduce cost in the weak channel
- Suggest a **CAC:LTV tracking dashboard** — What metrics would you include? Who sees it weekly?

Answer :-

1. Underperforming Channel : Facebook Ads

Among the three channels, Facebook Ads is clearly underperforming. Despite generating the highest number of leads (3,000), it has the lowest conversion rate (1%) and the highest cost per conversion (₹3,000). This indicates poor lead quality — likely due to broad targeting, irrelevant audience segments, or ineffective ad messaging. It's driving volume, but not delivering value.

2. Two Experiments to Optimize Facebook Ads

Experiment 1 : Refine Targeting with Lookalike Audiences

- Use custom audiences based on current paying customers to create lookalike profiles.
- Narrow targeting using parameters like job title (e.g., Founder, Operations Head), industry, company size, and location.
- Goal: Attract more qualified leads and reduce ad waste.

Experiment 2: A/B Test Different Ad Creatives & Hooks

1. Run parallel ad sets with distinct messaging :

- Set A: Pain-point focused copy (e.g., “Struggling with lead conversion?”)
- Set B: Proof-driven content (e.g., testimonials, success stories)

2. Track performance metrics (CTR, conversions) and reallocate budget to top performer.

3. Goal : Identify what narrative resonates with the right audience.

3. CAC:LTV Dashboard Recommendation

A centralized CAC-to-LTV dashboard should be implemented to monitor growth efficiency and guide strategic decisions. This dashboard would include :

Metric	Description
Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)	Per channel and overall
Customer Lifetime Value (LTV)	Average revenue per customer
CAC : LTV Ratio	Ideally should be 1:3 or better
Lead Conversion Rates	Across funnel stages : Lead → MQL → SQL → Customer
Drop-off Rates	Where leads are falling off in the funnel
Engagement Metrics	Email open/click rate, reply rate, demo booking rate
Channel ROI	Revenue vs spend per campaign

Stakeholders – Who Reviews This Weekly ?

- CEO : For top-level strategic clarity and budget allocation
- Growth Manager : To monitor funnel efficiency and propose experiments
- Sales & Marketing Leads : To align on campaigns and lead quality
- A simplified version can be shared with investors or advisors

“We do not scale what we do not understand. And we cannot reduce CAC without data-backed decisions.”

Part 4: Strategic Summary (Max 200 Words)

What's your philosophy when designing funnels?
How do you balance system design and real-world human unpredictability?
What role does **data storytelling** play in decision-making?

Answer :-

My funnel design philosophy is rooted in clarity, intent, and feedback loops. A good funnel is not just a path, it is a living system that guides prospects while learning from their behaviour. I design funnels with sharp entry/exit criteria at each stage, ensuring teams do not waste time on unqualified leads.

However, real humans do not move linearly. That is why my systems are flexible. I blend automation with human touchpoints, adapting flows based on behaviour, engagement, and context. For example, a cold lead might re-engage through a personal founder note, something a rigid system might ignore. So, while the framework is structured, the execution remains empathetic.

Data storytelling plays a critical role in this process. Numbers alone do not drive action, but stories do. I use dashboards not just to show what is happening, but to narrate why it is happening, and what to do next. When data becomes a conversation, decision-making becomes faster, smarter, and more aligned across teams.

At the core, my strategy balances logic with emotion, data with narrative, because growth is not just about efficiency, it is about earning trust at scale.